



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

avyāyac channavikrośan svāmine cānivedayan | 06.014a
voḍhum arhati gopas tāṃ vinayaṃ cāpi rājani || 14 || 06.014c
naṣṭavinaṣṭaṃ kṛmibhiḥ śvahataṃ viṣame mṛtam | 06.015a
hīnaṃ puruṣakāreṇa gopāyaiva nipātayet || 15 || 06.015c

— Nāradaśmṛti, Chapter 6, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

These verses from the Nāradaśmṛiti, while seemingly focused on the duties of a herdsman, offer a profound reflection on responsibility and accountability that resonates deeply in our modern lives. The passage essentially outlines situations where a herdsman is held liable for the loss or damage of cattle under their care. It speaks of instances where the herdsman fails to protect the animals from harm, neglects to report incidents to the owner, or doesn't take appropriate action to prevent loss. He is accountable for negligence.

However, let's consider this beyond the literal. The cattle can be seen as symbolic of anything entrusted to your care: your relationships, your career, your health, or even your spiritual progress. The herdsman then becomes a representation of you, the guardian of these precious aspects of your life. The message then encourages you to take ownership of your responsibilities and to act with diligence and foresight.

The verses also highlight instances where the herdsman is not held liable – for example, if the cattle die from natural causes, accidents beyond their control, or due to circumstances where human intervention would have been ineffective. This provides a crucial balance, reminding you to accept what is beyond your control and to avoid unnecessary self-blame. It emphasizes the importance of distinguishing between genuine responsibility and the acceptance of unavoidable circumstances.

In today's fast-paced world, it's easy to feel overwhelmed and disconnected from the consequences of our actions. This passage urges you to cultivate a mindful approach to your responsibilities. It prompts you to examine your actions, acknowledge your mistakes, and learn from them. It encourages you to act with integrity and to prioritize the well-being of what you have been entrusted with, recognizing that your choices have a direct impact on the outcome. Ultimately, this ancient wisdom invites you to live a life of conscious awareness, where you are both accountable for your actions and accepting of the inevitable challenges that arise.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you truly tending to the "cattle" in your life with the diligence and care they deserve, or are you letting them wander unattended, vulnerable to unseen dangers?